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Publication >

# The price of inaction: the global private, fiscal and social costs of children and youth not learning

First global report illustrating the monetary costs to economies around the world of leaving children and youth behind in education.

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## The price of inaction: the global private, fiscal and social costs of children and youth not learning

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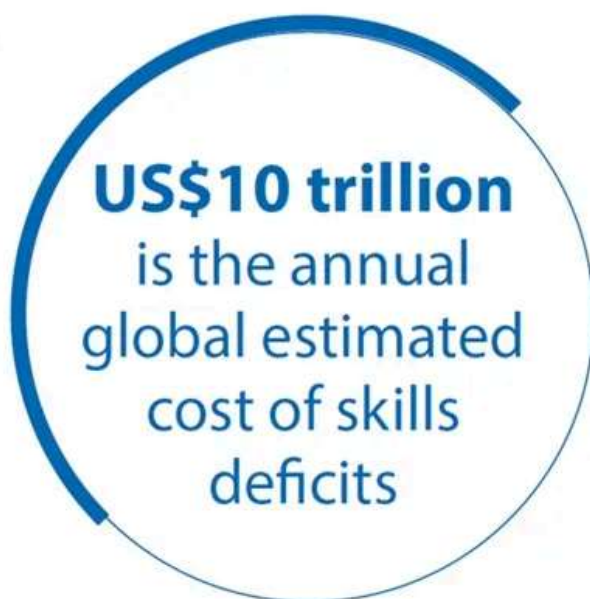
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## What it costs globally when children and youth are not learning

Despite efforts by countries, the number of out-of-school children remains significant, with 128 million boys and 122 million girls excluded from schooling. Educational skills deficits are also immense – 57 per cent of the world's children have not gained basicskill levels.

UNESCO, OECD and the Commonwealth Secretariat have developed the first global report to illustrate the monetary costs to economies around the world of leaving children and youth behind in education.



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Using available evidence, the report calculates the costs, globally and by region, of children and youth that are not in

school or gaining basic skills. Calculations are also provided for twenty selected countries in which there are gender disparities in education at either girls' or boys' expense. If governments were to increase efforts so that every child was in school, the future world GDP would raise by more than US\$6.5 trillion annually, not to mention eliminating the social costs of failure.

This publication offers the evidence and insights that show that for economic development to accelerate, so must prioritizations and investments in education and gender-transformative action.



### **Q&A: What you need to know about 'the price of inaction' in education**



### **Out-of-school children and educational gaps**

cost the global economy \$10,000 billion a year  
(press release)



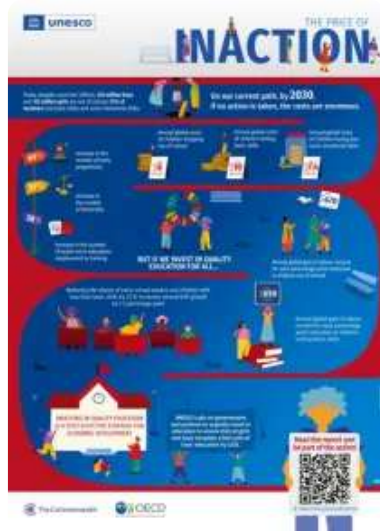
## The price of inaction: the global private, fiscal and social costs of children and youth not learning; country profiles

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## Infographic

**UNESCO,  
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→ UNESCO's work on gender equality and education

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